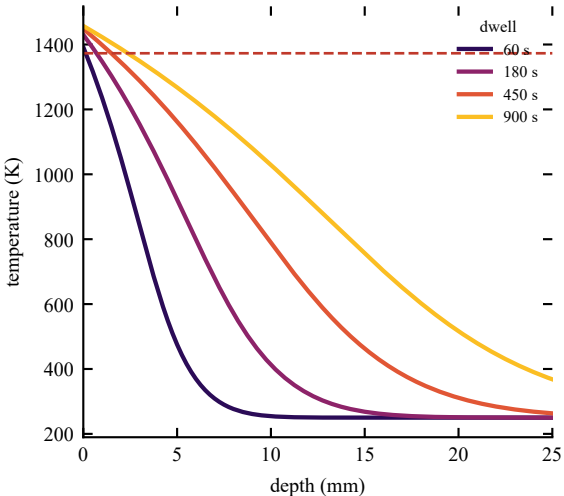


(a) Sintering is confined to a thin near-surface layer



(b) Sintered depth grows slowly

